



Class Recordings

User Manual

App version 0.4.1 · August 2026

Welcome! This guide explains everything the Sabeel Class Recordings app can do — from listening to your first class to taking attendance and tracking who has caught up. It is organized by role: **students** start with Part 1; **staff** (managers and admins) add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick “How do I...?” index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (<https://sabeel-class-recordings.web.app>) and the Android app — same account, same data, live everywhere. Every screen in this guide is shown twice: once **on a phone** and once **on a computer**, so you can recognize it wherever you are.

The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **Recordings are audio only.** Each one is the sound of one class meeting — no video. They stream in the app; nothing is downloaded to fill up your phone, and each play link is freshly issued and expires, so recordings stay inside the app.
2. **The app is for catching up on a class you were excused from.** Staff take **attendance** for each meeting. If they mark you **excused**, that meeting’s recording opens to you and becomes *required listening* — it appears on your home screen with a date to listen by, and closes again after it. If you were **present**, you don’t need it. If you were **absent** without being excused, it isn’t opened to you. Being excused is the whole of it.
3. **You mark your own listening complete.** The app saves your place and shows how much you’ve heard, but *you* decide when you’re done — it is on your honor. (The one rule: you have to have pressed play at least once.)
4. **Staff can see who has caught up.** For every recording there is a ledger: of the students who were excused, who has finished and who missed the date — plus, for the record, who was present and who was absent. Staff can export it and, with a written reason, mark a completion on someone’s behalf.
5. **Everything important is written down.** Approvals, overrides and edits are recorded in an audit history that admins can review.

That’s the whole system. Everything below is detail.

Part 1 — For students

1.1 Signing in

Class Recordings

Sabeel Institute

Staff

Sign in with your Sabeel Google account. New accounts need an admin to approve them before they can be used.

Sign in with Google

Students

Use the email address your teacher registered, and the password you set from the emailed link.

Email

you@example.com

Password

Sign in

Email me a password link

Emulator sign-in (dev only)

as faisal.shah (first admin)

as manager

as outsider (gets deleted)

On a phone

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v0.3.1 - dev

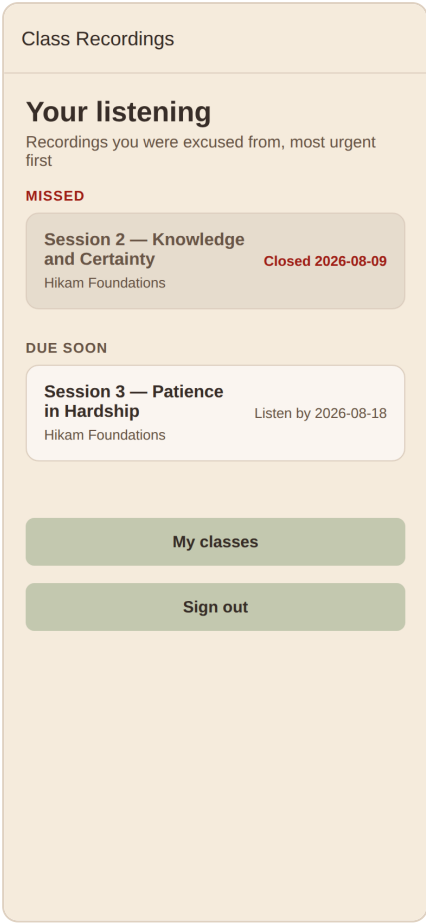
On a computer

Open the app or the website. Under **Students**, enter the **email address your teacher registered** and your password, then tap **Sign in**.

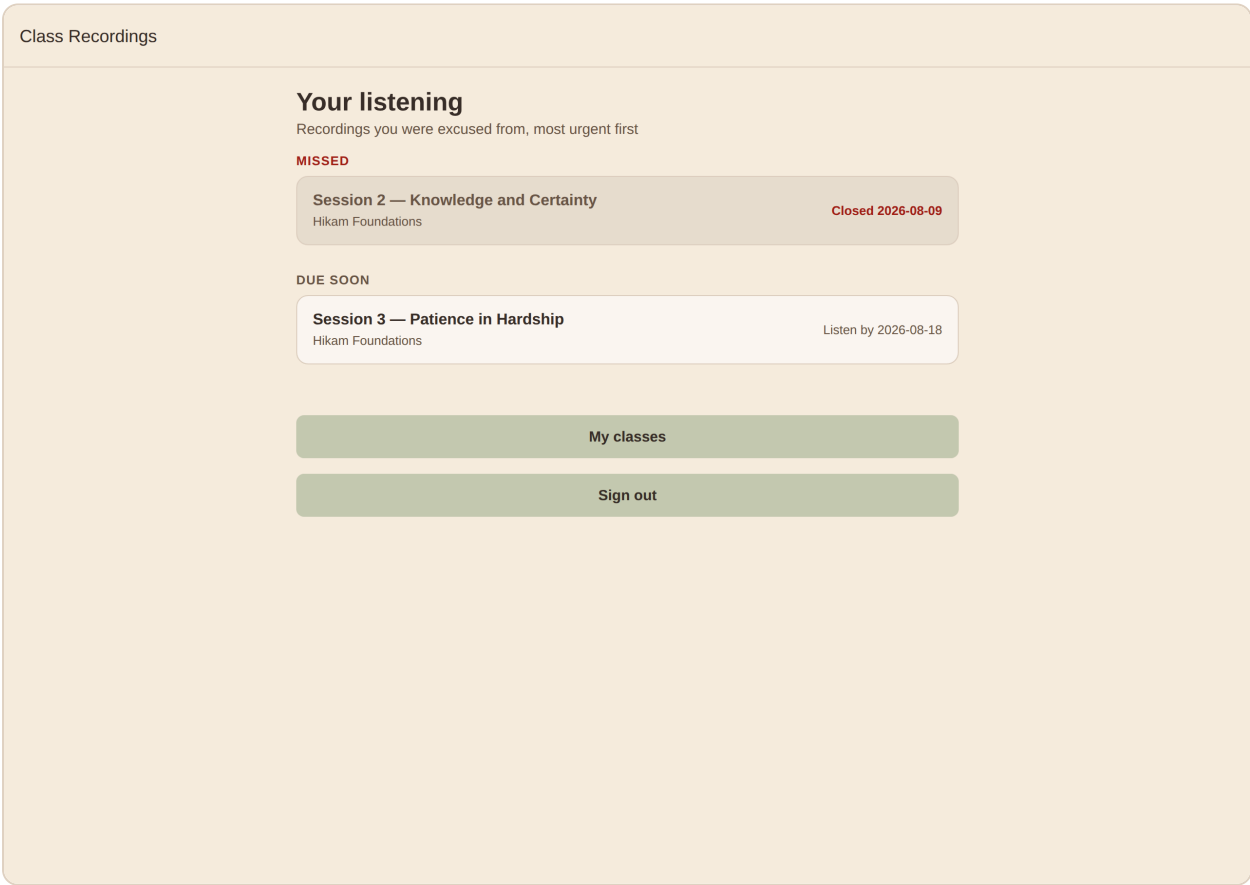
Your first password comes from an email. When your teacher creates your account, the app sends you a “set your password” link — open it, choose a password, and you’re ready. If you never received it or the link has expired, tap **Email me a password link** on this screen to get a fresh one.

The **Staff** section at the top is only for teachers and administrators — you don’t need it.

1.2 Your listening list



On a phone



This is your home screen — **Your listening**. It holds every recording that has been opened to you, most urgent first.

A recording is opened to you when your teacher marks you *excused* for that class. That is the whole rule. If you were there, you don't need it; if you missed a class without being excused, it isn't opened to you. So this one list is both what you *may* listen to and what you *need* to listen to — there is no separate archive to go hunting through.

It's grouped so nothing slips past you:

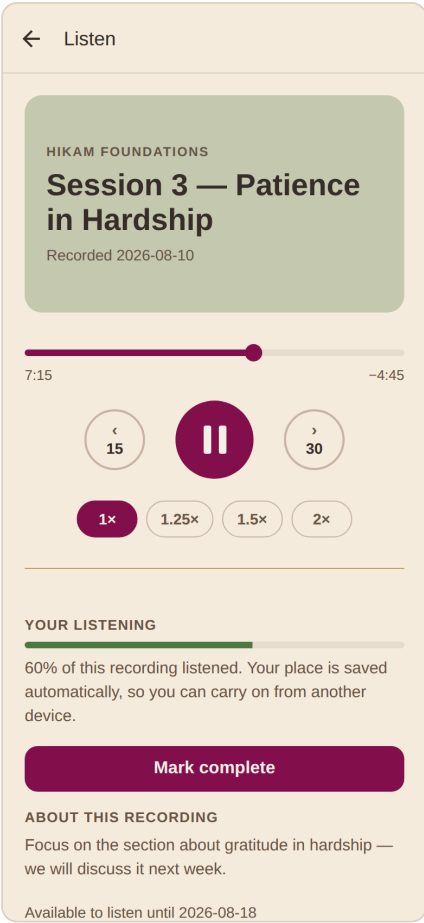
- **Missed** — the date to listen by has passed. Shown in red, with the date it closed.
- **Due soon** — the date to listen by is within the next week.
- **Upcoming** — opened to you, with more time.
- **Completed** — recordings you've already marked done.

Each card shows the recording's title, which class it's from, and **Listen by** its date. Tap any card to open it and listen.

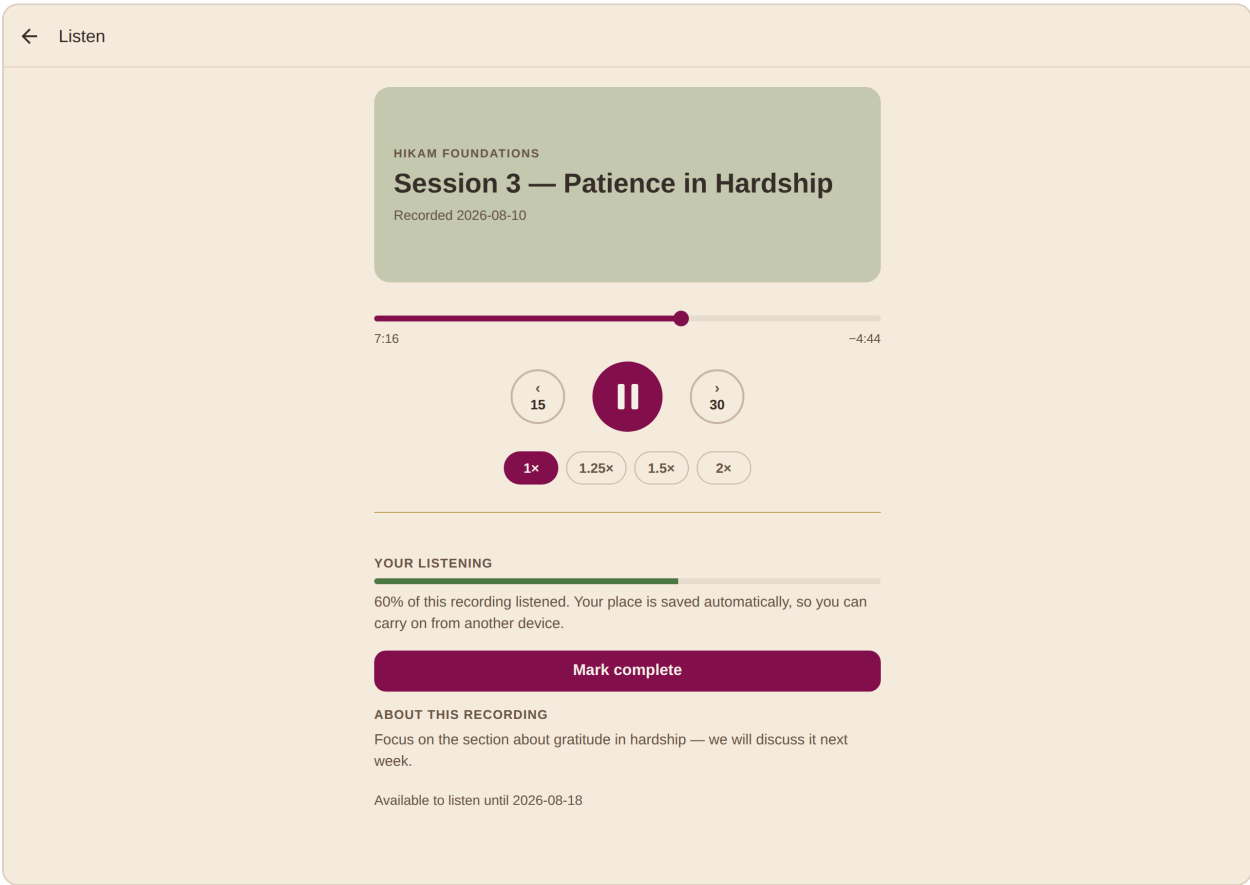
Every recording has a closing date. After it passes you can no longer play that recording — the card stays on your list marked *Missed*, so you can still see what it was, but the audio is closed. If you need it reopened, ask your teacher: they can move the date.

One thing worth knowing: if you finish a recording and mark it complete *before* the date, it stays **Completed** forever. It is never turned into a “missed” the next day.

1.3 Listening to a recording



On a phone



The player has everything you'd expect from a podcast app:

- **The big round button** plays and pauses.
- The two side buttons **skip back 15 seconds** and **skip ahead 30 seconds** — handy for re-hearing a point or moving past a pause.
- **1× / 1.25× / 1.5× / 2×** change the speed without changing the pitch.
- Drag the **progress bar** to jump anywhere. The times below it show how far in you are and how much is left.

A bar shows roughly how much of the recording you've heard. **Your place is saved automatically**, so you can stop on your phone on the bus and pick up on your laptop at home — it remembers where you were.

If the teacher left a note, it appears under **About this recording** — often “focus on this part” or “we'll discuss this next week.”

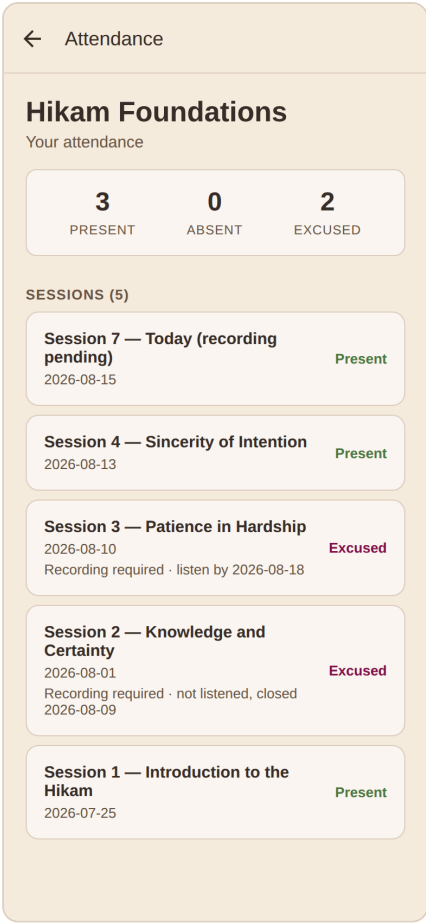
1.4 Marking a recording complete

The **Mark complete** button is at the bottom of the player. Tap it when you've finished listening, and the recording moves to your **Completed** section.

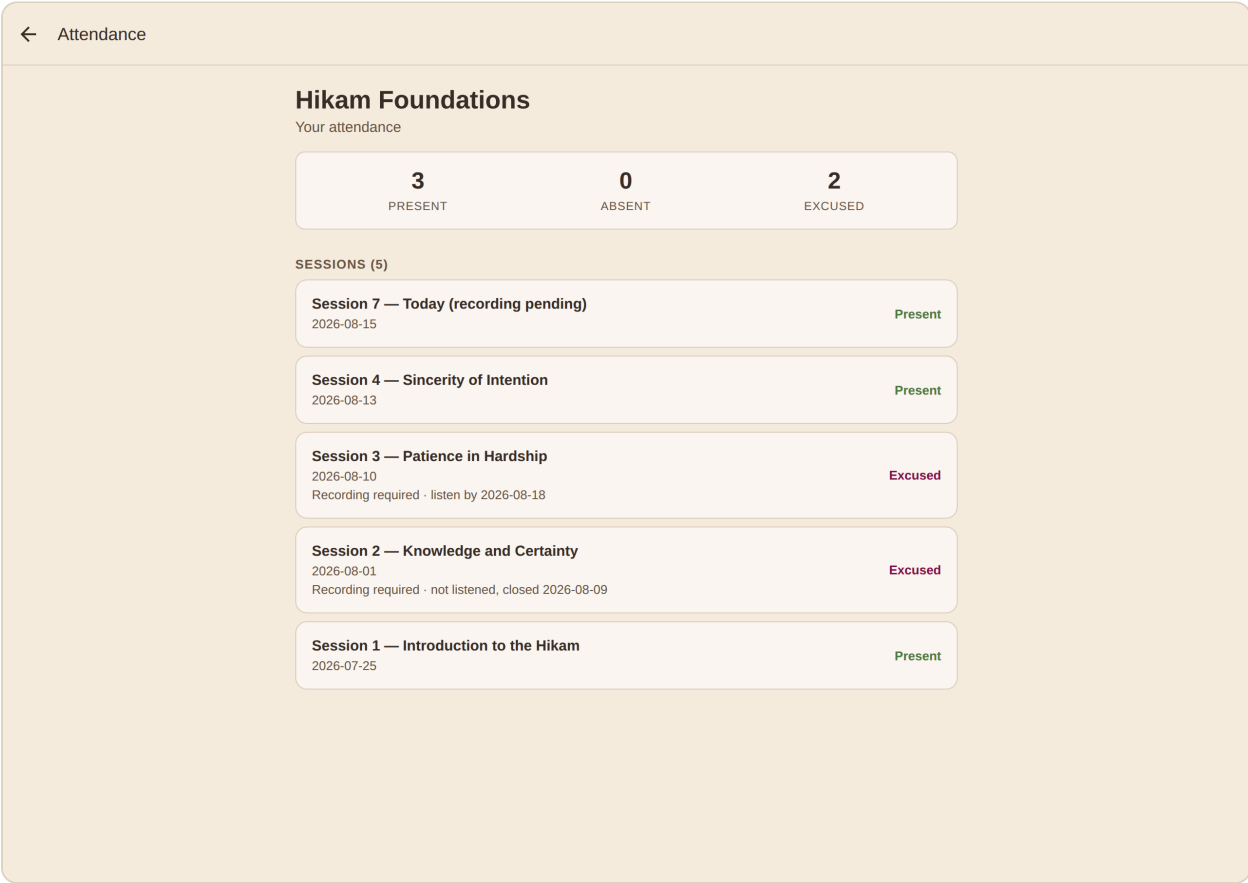
A few things worth knowing:

- **It's on your honor.** The app doesn't force you to listen to every second — it trusts you to mark complete when you're genuinely done. The listening bar is there to help *you* keep your place, not to police you.
- **You do have to press play first.** The button only unlocks once you've started the recording — you can't mark something complete you've never opened.
- **Changed your mind?** You can open a completed recording again and listen more; marking complete isn't a locked door.

1.5 Your attendance record



On a phone



Tap **My classes** at the bottom of your home screen to see the classes you're enrolled in, then tap one to see **your own attendance** for it.

At the top is a tally — how many meetings you were **present** for, **absent** from, and **excused** from. Below it, every meeting your teacher recorded you in, newest first, with the date and your own mark.

Where you were excused, the row also says that a recording was required and whether you've listened to it — so you can check your record without hunting through your listening list.

Two things this page is not: it isn't a way to play anything (that's your home screen), and it never shows anyone else's attendance. You see your own marks and nobody else's.

1.6 Listening on a spotty connection

The app is built to survive a bad signal. If you mark a recording complete while you're offline or your connection drops, the app **holds onto that** and syncs it the moment you're back online — even if you close the app in between. You may briefly see a “pending” state; that just means “saved on this device, not yet sent.” You don't have to do anything; it sorts itself out.

Streaming the audio itself does need a connection, so for a long class on the go, a stable network (or Wi-Fi before you leave) is your friend.

1.7 Notifications

The app can send you two messages, and only two. Tap **Notifications** at the bottom of your home screen to turn either off:

- **A recording is ready for me** — when a class you were excused from has a recording you can listen to. Worth leaving on: it's the only way you'll know one has appeared.
- **Last day to listen** — on the morning of the day a recording closes, if you haven't finished it.

Both start switched on. There's deliberately no message *after* a recording closes: by then there'd be nothing you could do about it.

Your choices follow you — they apply on every device you sign in on. If the screen says this device can't receive notifications, they're switched off for the app in your phone's own settings, or you're in a browser that doesn't support them.

Part 2 — For staff

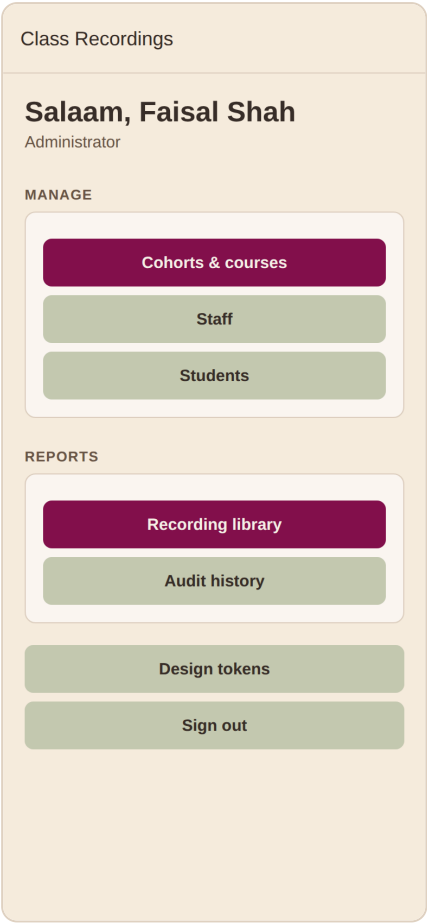
Managers and admins both use this section. A few actions are admin-only and are marked; managers see only the courses they've been assigned to.

2.1 Signing in and getting approved

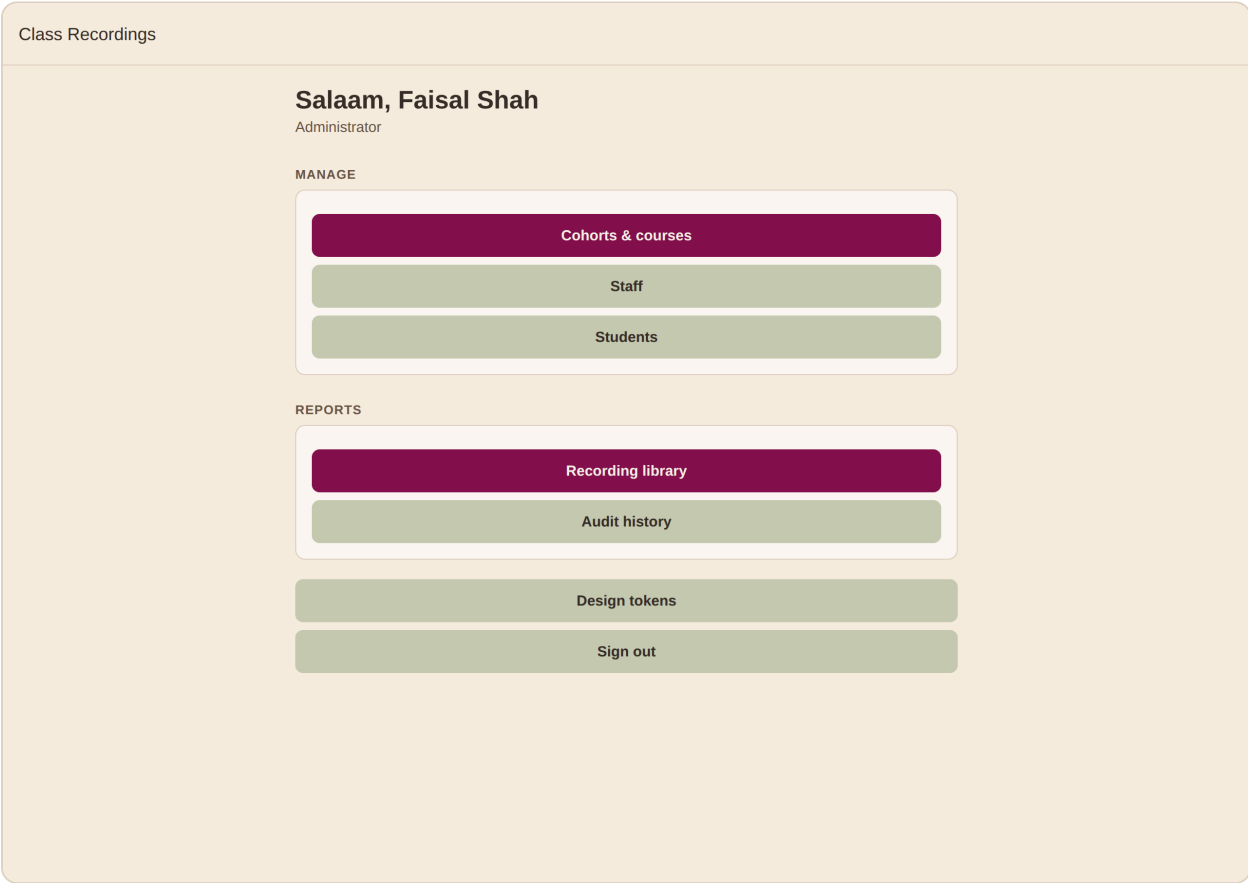
Staff sign in differently from students. On the sign-in screen, use **Sign in with Google** with your Sabeel Google account.

The first time, you'll wait for approval. New staff accounts start as *pending* — an administrator has to approve you and choose your role before you can do anything. Once they do, sign in again and you're in. (If you're the very first administrator, that step was done for you during setup.)

2.2 The staff home



On a phone



Your home screen is a hub, grouped into what you **manage** and what you **report** on:

- **Cohorts & courses** — the heart of the app: terms, courses, their sessions and recordings, and the ledgers that track them.
- **Staff** (*admin only*) — approve new staff and set roles.
- **Students** (*admin only*) — create student accounts and manage access.
- **Recording library** — every recording across every course you can see, with filters.
- **Audit history** — the record of who did what.

Managers see a smaller version of this — just what they need for their own courses.

2.3 Cohorts, courses, and a course at a glance

The structure is **Cohort → Course → Session → Recording**. A **cohort** is a term or intake (like “Autumn 2026”). A **course** is a subject taught over that term. A **session** is one dated meeting of the course, and a **recording** is the audio of that meeting.

← Cohorts

Semesters, and the courses inside them

ADD A COHORT

Name

Autumn 2026

Create cohort

COHORTS (1)

Autumn 2026
2 courses

▾ ARCHIVED (1)

Spring 2026
1 course

On a phone

← Cohorts

Semesters, and the courses inside them

ADD A COHORT

Name

Autumn 2026

Create cohort

COHORTS (1)

Autumn 2026
2 courses

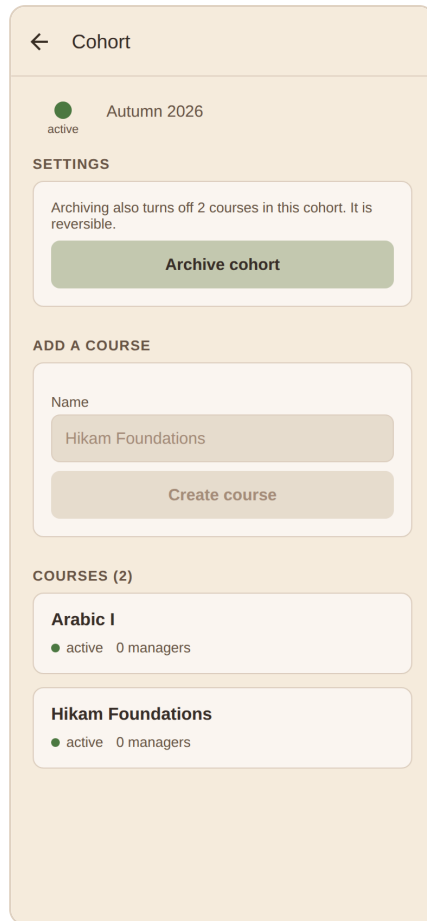
▾ ARCHIVED (1)

Spring 2026
1 course

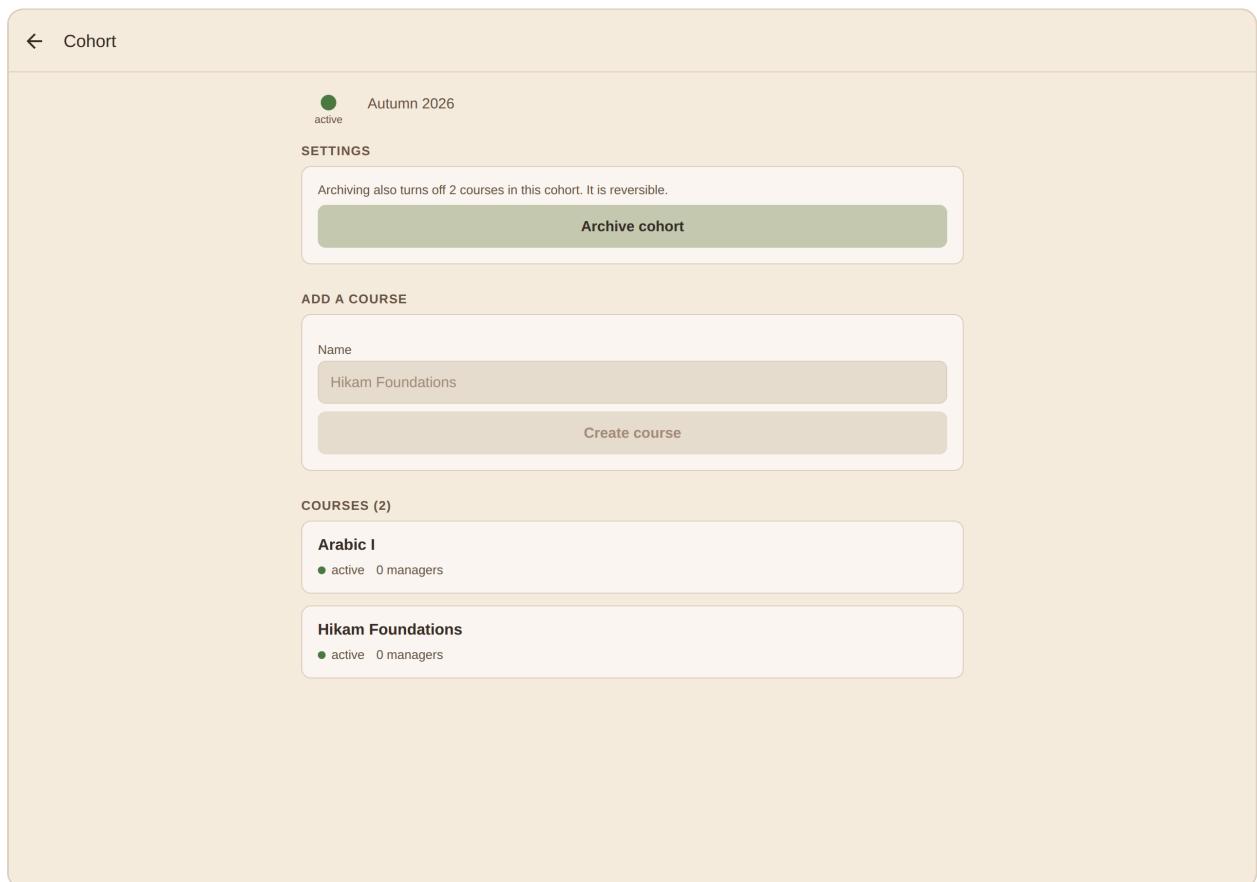
On a computer

Finished terms move into an **Archived** section at the bottom of the cohort list — tap the heading to open it.

Open a cohort to see **its settings and its courses**, and open a course to work with it. Archiving a cohort lives on the cohort's own page, not on the list, in the same way a course is archived from the course page. Archiving a cohort turns off every course in it; reactivating puts each course back to the setting it had.

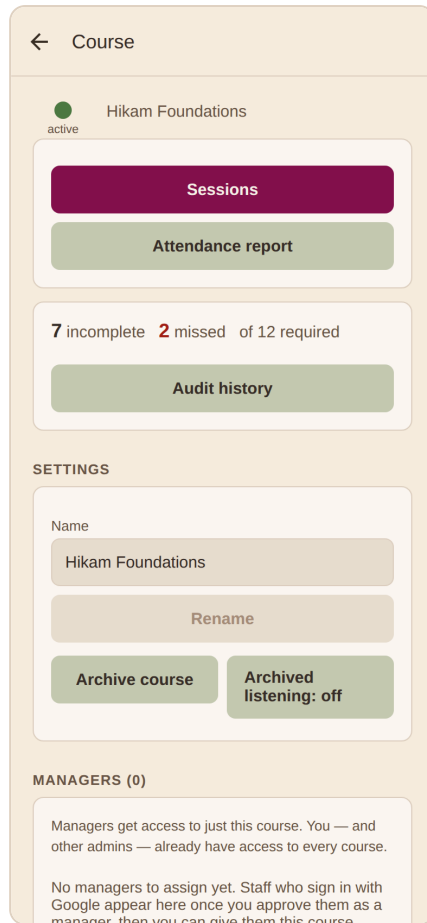


On a phone

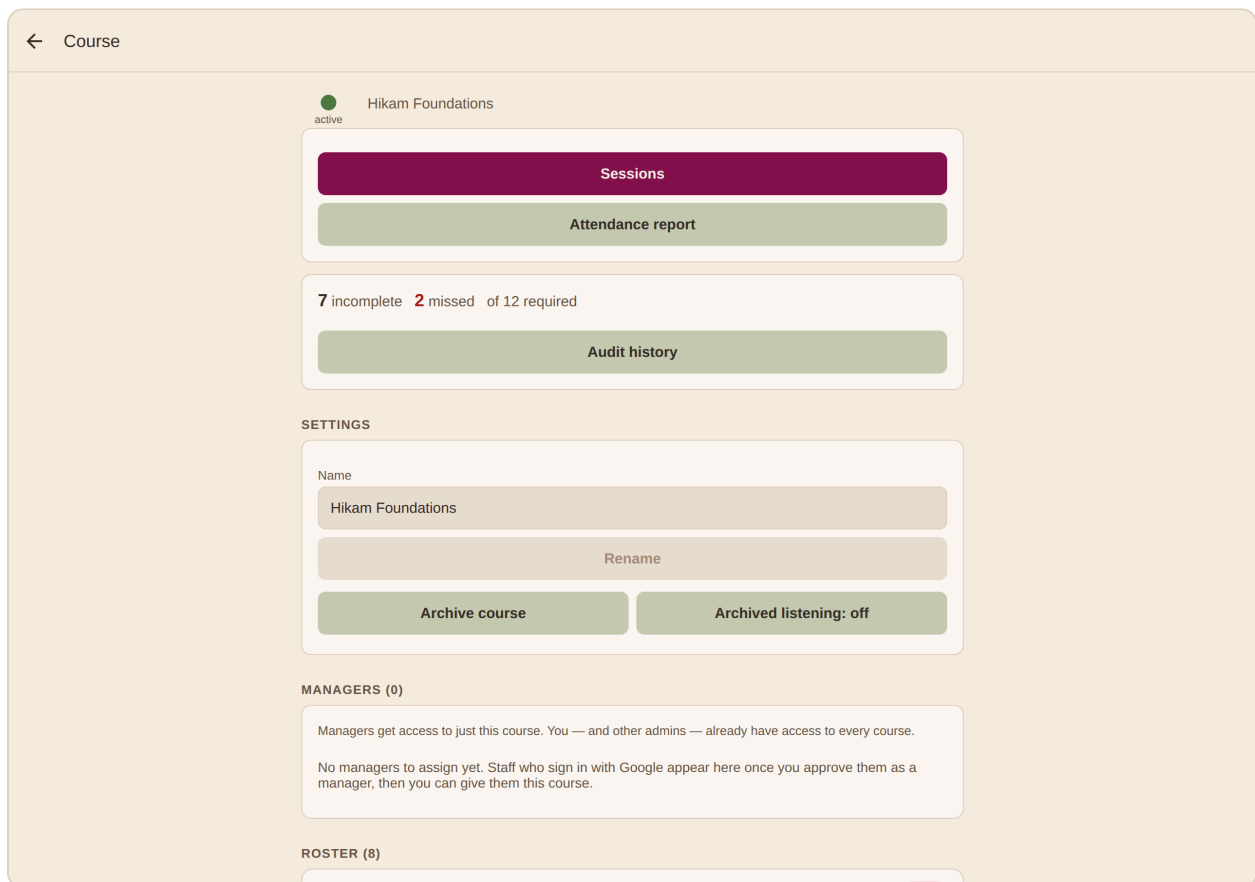


On a computer

The **course page** is your dashboard for that course:



On a phone



On a computer

- **Sessions** takes you to the course's meetings, where attendance and recordings live (Section 2.4).
- **Attendance report** summarizes attendance and catch-up across the whole course (Section 2.9).
- The counts card — *incomplete / missed of N required* — is the whole course's catch-up at a glance, and links straight to the course **Audit history**.
- **Settings** lets you rename the course, **archive** it when the term ends, and choose whether students may still listen to an archived course's recordings.
- **Managers** lists the staff assigned to *this* course. Managers only ever see and act on the courses they're assigned to here — being in a cohort grants nothing by itself.
- **Roster** lists the enrolled students. Tap a student to see their personal ledger for the course (Section 2.8).

2.4 Sessions, attendance, and adding a recording

← Sessions

Hikam Foundations

ADD A SESSION

Title

Session 1 — Introduction

Date of the meeting

08/15/2026

Listen by

08/22/2026

Create session

SESSIONS (7)

Session 7 — Today (recording pending)

2026-08-15

Attendance taken

No recording

Session 6 — (import needs review)

2026-08-14

Attendance not taken

Recording added

Session 5 — Reliance and Trust

2026-08-14

Attendance not taken

Recording added

On a phone

← Sessions

Hikam Foundations

ADD A SESSION

Title

Session 1 — Introduction

Date of the meeting

08/15/2026

Listen by

08/22/2026

Create session

SESSIONS (7)

Session 7 — Today (recording pending)

2026-08-15

Attendance taken

No recording

Session 6 — (import needs review)

2026-08-14

Attendance not taken

Recording added

Session 5 — Reliance and Trust

2026-08-14

Attendance not taken

Recording added

Session 4 — Simplicity of Intention

2026-08-13

Attendance not taken

Recording added

A **session** is one class meeting. Create one for each meeting — give it a title, its date, and a **Listen by** date. Each session card shows at a glance whether **attendance** has been taken and whether a **recording** has been added, so you can see what's still outstanding.

The “Listen by” date is required, and it matters more than it looks. It is the day the recording *closes* to the students you excused — after it, they can no longer play it. It fills in automatically as a week after the meeting; change it to whatever suits. You can't set it in the past, and you can move it forward later to reopen a session for someone who needs longer.

The **course name under the heading is a link** — on the sessions list, on a session, and on the attendance report. Tap it to go straight back to the course. The back arrow takes you one step back the way you came; this takes you to the course itself, however many steps in you are, and it works even when you have opened a session from a link somebody sent you.

Open a session to work with it:



Take attendance. For each enrolled student, choose **Present**, **Absent**, or **Excused**, then tap **Submit attendance**. Everyone starts as *Present*, so often you only flip the few who missed. You can re-submit a corrected attendance later and everything updates automatically.

Excusing a student is what gives them the recording. It is the only mark that does:

- **Present** — they were there. Nothing is required of them, and the recording is not opened to them.
- **Excused** — they missed it with your permission. The recording opens to them and listening to it is required, until the Listen by date.
- **Absent** — they missed it without being excused. Nothing is opened to them.

So **Mark all excused** is the one-tap shortcut for “everyone must listen to this one.” And if someone genuinely needs to catch up on a class you marked them absent for, just change their mark to Excused and submit again.

One limit worth knowing: you can’t excuse anyone for a session whose Listen by date has already passed — it would hand them something they could never open. Move the date forward first, then excuse them.

Add the recording. In the same screen, **Upload audio...** or import it from Zoom. It’s **audio only** — up to 300 MB, though a two-hour class is normally well under 30 MB. (Uploading audio rather than a video file is the single biggest thing that keeps this app free to run.) The recording takes its title, date, and notes from the session, so you don’t retype them.

Each recording moves through a few states:

- **Draft** — added, not yet visible to students. You can replace its audio freely.
- **Published** — live. The students you excused can now listen, and are on the hook for it. Publishing is blocked if the session’s Listen by date has already passed, because nobody would be able to open it.
- **Needs attention** — flagged for a problem (for example, a Zoom import that needs review). Publish is blocked until it has audio.

2.5 How a recording becomes required listening

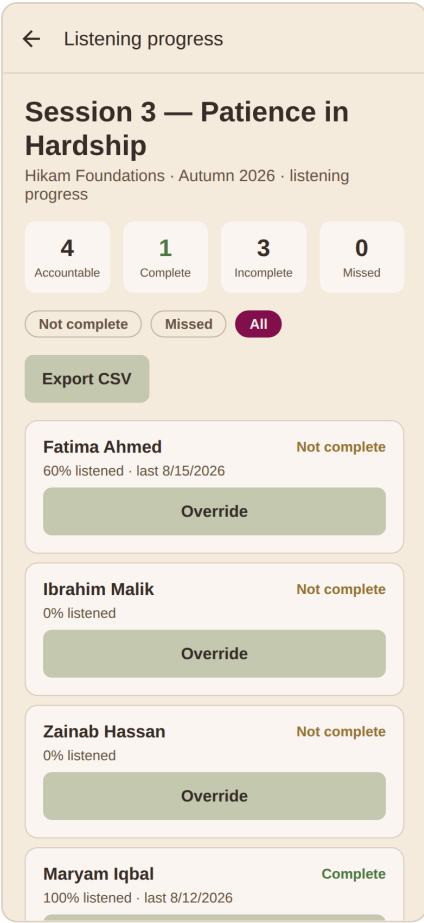
Here’s the rule that runs the whole ledger:

A recording opens to the students marked EXCUSED for its session, and to nobody else — automatically, once the recording is **published** and its attendance has been **submitted**. The same fact makes listening required. It closes again when the session's **Listen by** date passes.

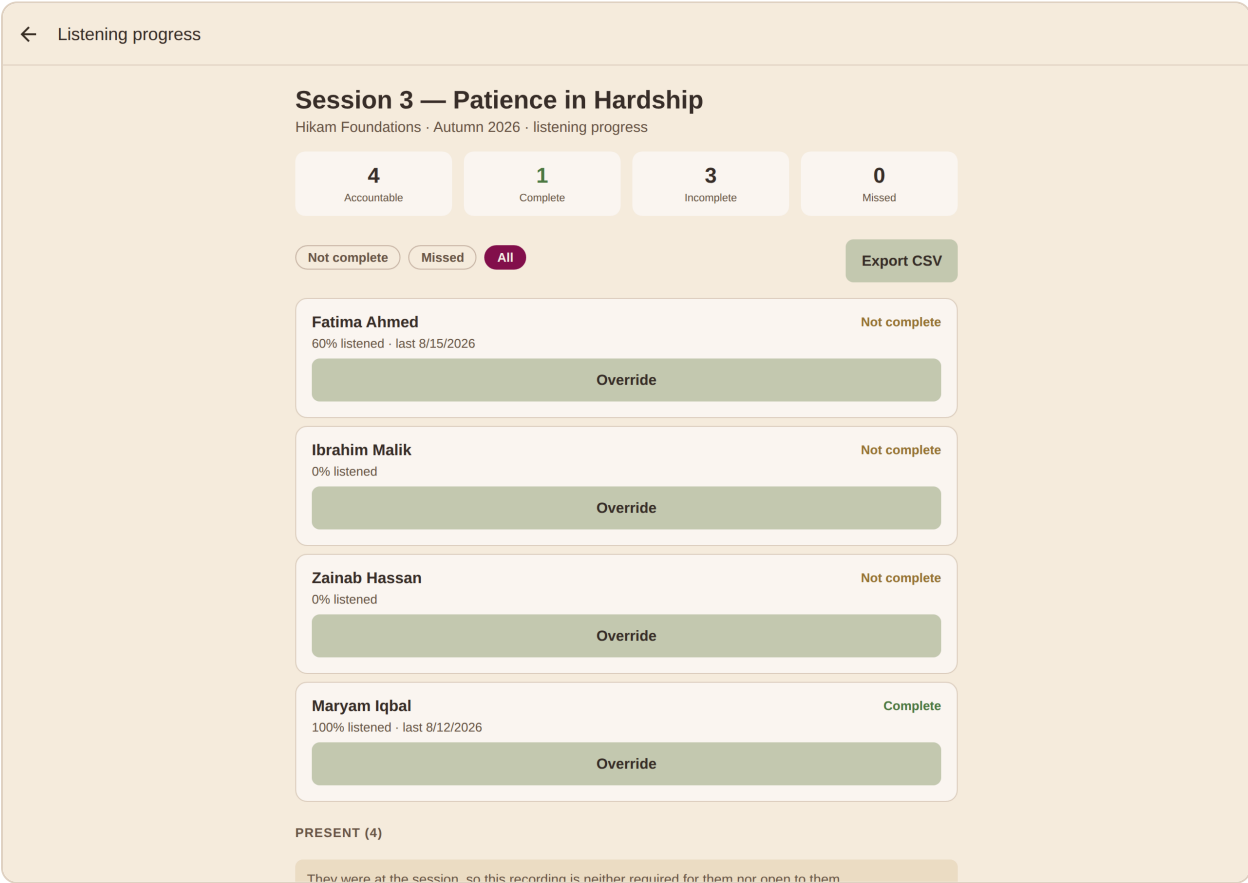
You never assign students one by one; the attendance sheet is the assignment. If you correct attendance — flip someone from excused to present, or the reverse — access and obligations update to match, and any listening or completion already recorded is kept.

- **Being enrolled opens nothing.** A student in the class who was present, or absent without being excused, cannot play the recording at all.
- **The Listen by date closes it.** After that day the student sees the recording on their list marked *Missed*, with the date it closed, and can no longer play it. Move the session's Listen by date forward to reopen it.
- **A student who joins late** wasn't on the roster when earlier attendance was taken, so they are **not** retroactively given those older sessions. If you *do* want a latecomer to catch up on an earlier one, open that session, mark them **Excused**, and re-submit attendance.
- **Unpublishing** a recording closes it to everyone again.

2.6 The recording ledger — who has caught up



On a phone



Open a published recording's **Listening progress** (from its session) to see exactly where things stand. Up top, four counts: **accountable** (the students you excused, the only ones who can open it), **complete**, **incomplete**, and **missed**.

The screen has four parts:

- **The accountable list** — the students you excused, each with how much they've listened, when they last listened, and their status: **Complete**, **Not complete**, or **Missed**. The **filter chips** — *Not complete / Missed / All* — open on **Not complete**, so you land on exactly the people who still need a nudge.
- **Present** — the students who were there. The recording is neither required for them nor open to them.
- **Absent** — marked absent rather than excused, so it was never opened to them. To let one of them catch up, mark them **Excused** on the session and submit again.
- **Also listened** — listening from someone who no longer holds the recording, for example a student you excused, who listened, and whom you then corrected to present. Kept as history.

Export CSV downloads the accountable rows — the same rows, the same filter — as a spreadsheet, for records or a follow-up.

2.7 Overriding a completion

←

Listening progress

Session 3 — Patience in Hardship

Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026 · listening progress

4

Accountable

1

Complete

3

Incomplete

0

Missed

Not complete

Missed

All

Export CSV

Fatima Ahmed

Not complete

60% listened · last 8/15/2026

Reason (required, recorded in the audit log)

e.g. attended in person

Mark complete

Mark not complete

Cancel

Ibrahim Malik

Not complete

0% listened

Override

Zainab Hassan

Not complete

0% listened

Override

On a phone

←

Listening progress

Session 3 — Patience in Hardship

Hikam Foundations · Autumn 2026 · listening progress

4

Accountable

1

Complete

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Override

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Not complete

0% listened

Override

PRESENT (4)

Sometimes the ledger and reality differ — a student caught up in person, or listened on someone else’s device. Tap **Override** on their row to set the status yourself:

- Enter a **reason** — it’s **required**, and it’s written into the audit history so there’s always a record of why. “Caught up with the teacher one-on-one” is a good example.
- Choose **Mark complete** or **Mark not complete**.

An override **wins over the student’s own mark**. If you mark someone complete and they later fiddle with their own status, your override stands. To undo it, open the row again and **Remove override** — the status falls back to whatever the student’s own listening says. Every override, and every removal, is audited.

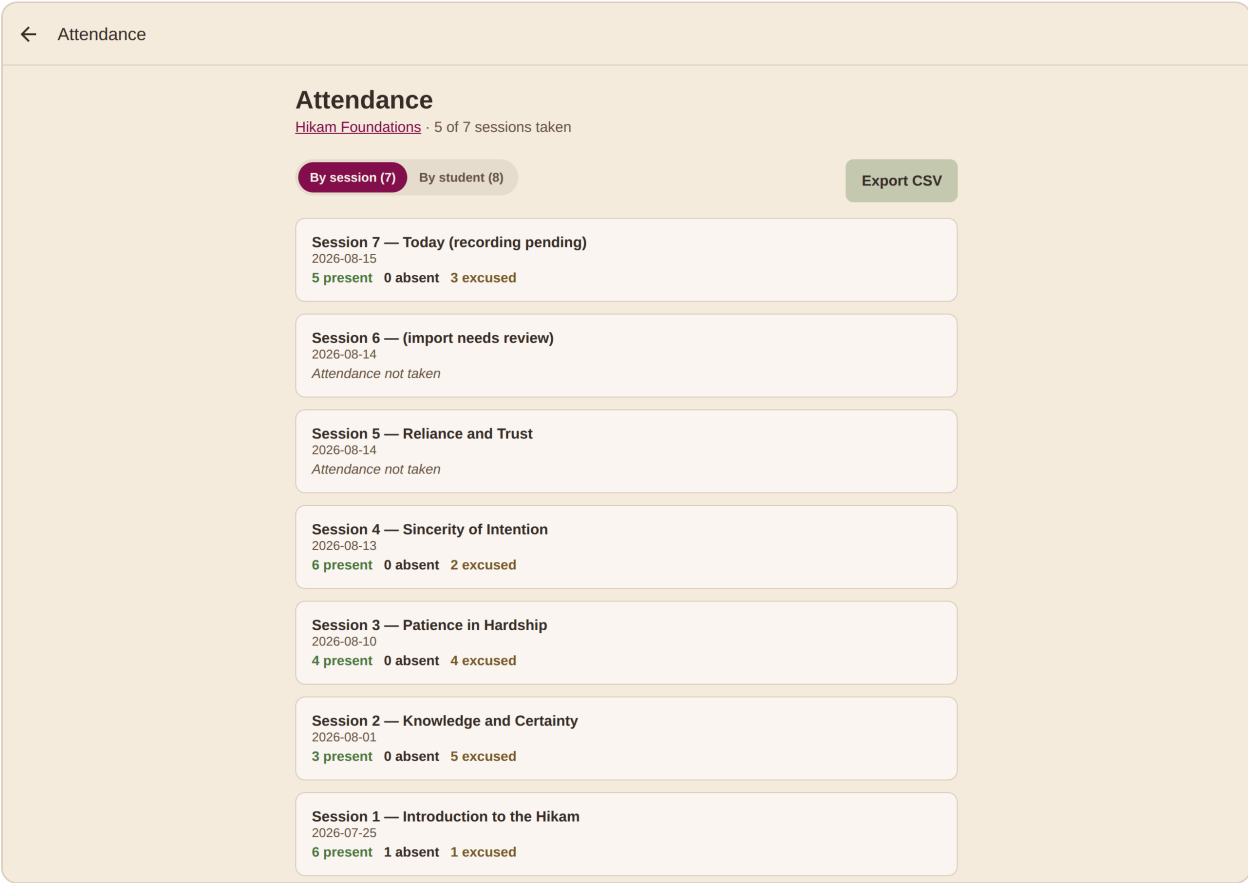
2.8 One student’s ledger

From a course’s **Roster**, tap a student to see *their* view: the recordings they’re required to catch up on in that course, each with its status, the same action-first filters, and its own **Export CSV**. It’s the per-person counterpart to the per-recording ledger in 2.6 — the right screen when a parent or student asks “where do I stand?”

2.9 The attendance report



On a phone



Reached from the course page, the **attendance report** rolls the whole course up two ways — a toggle switches between them:

- **By session** — every session with its present / absent / excused counts, and a clear flag on any meeting where attendance was never taken.
- **By student** — each student's attendance across the course (chronic absentees first), plus their **catch-up** status: of the recordings they were excused from, how many are complete and how many they missed.

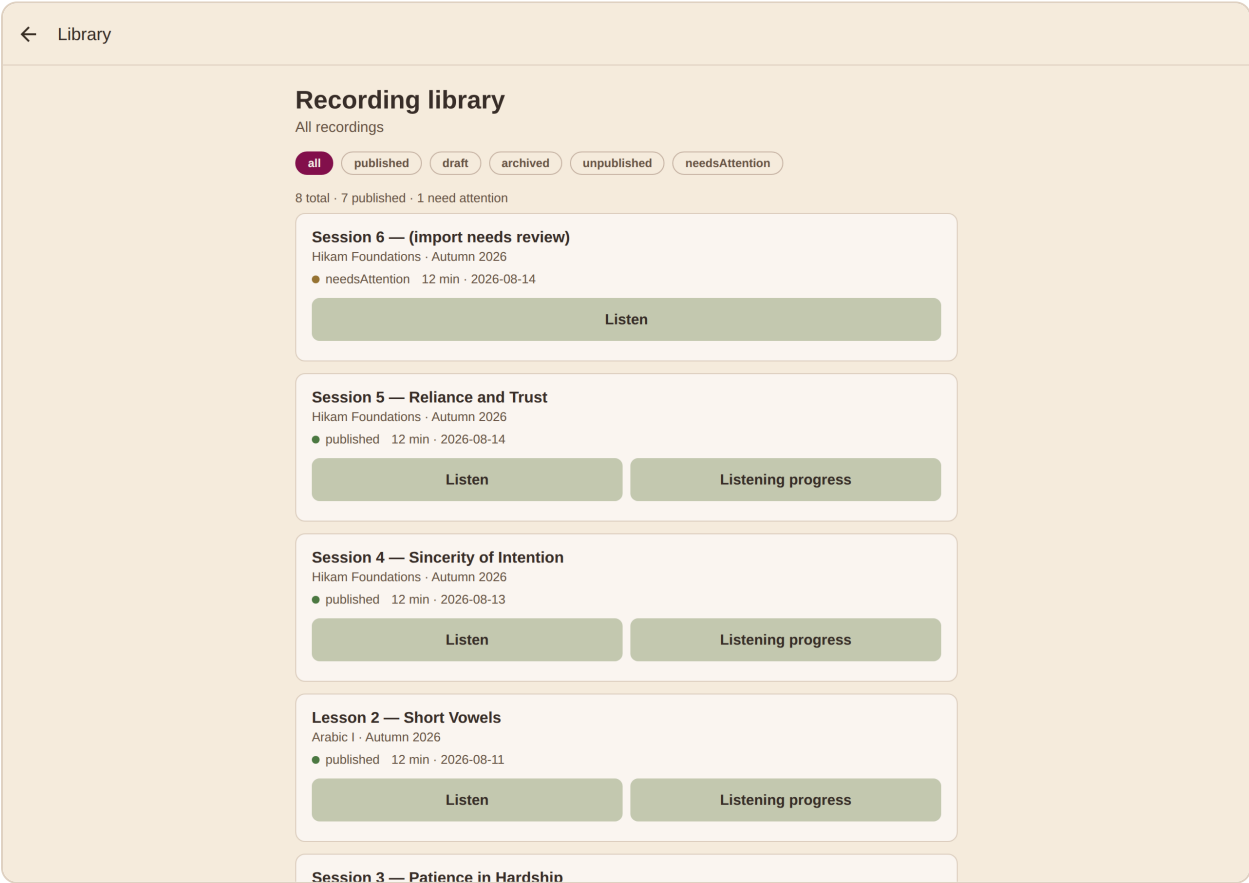
Each view has its own **Export CSV**.

Tap any card to go straight to the detail. A session opens that session — its attendance roster and its recording; a student opens that student's listening progress for the course. So the report is where you spot the problem, and one tap is where you deal with it.

2.10 The recording library



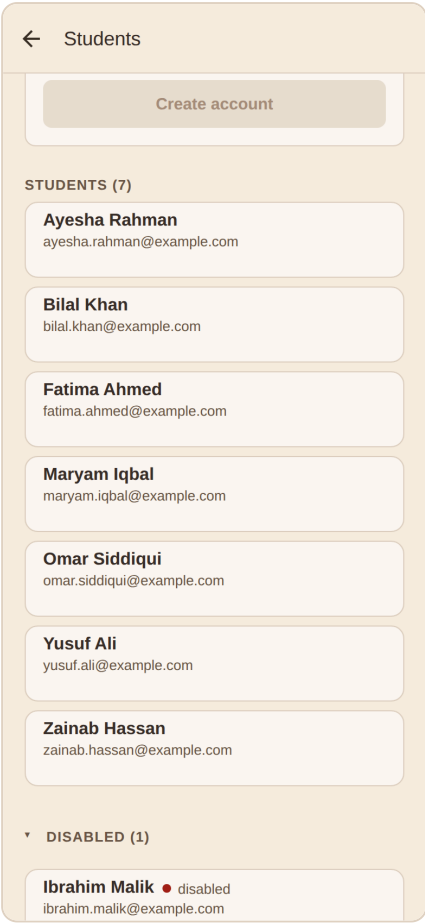
On a phone



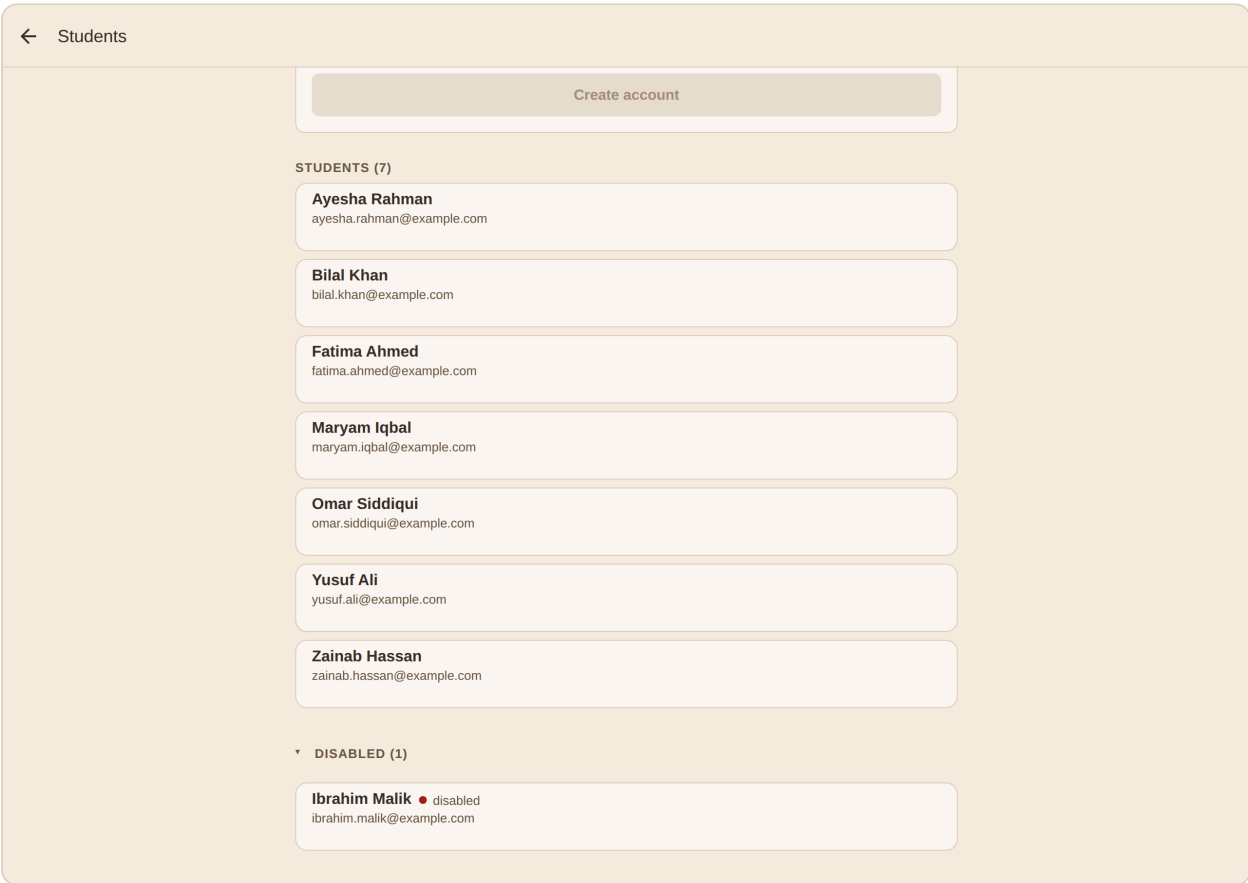
On a computer

The **library** is every recording you can see, across all your courses, in one list — with a count summary and filters for **published / draft / archived / unpublished / needs attention**. It's the fastest way to answer “which recordings still need audio?” or “what's flagged?” without walking course by course. Admins see everything; managers see their assigned courses.

2.11 Managing students (admin)



On a phone

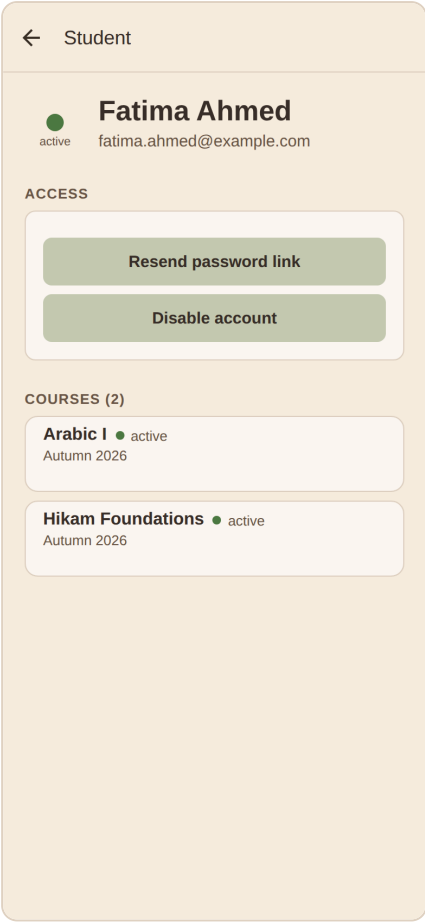


On a computer

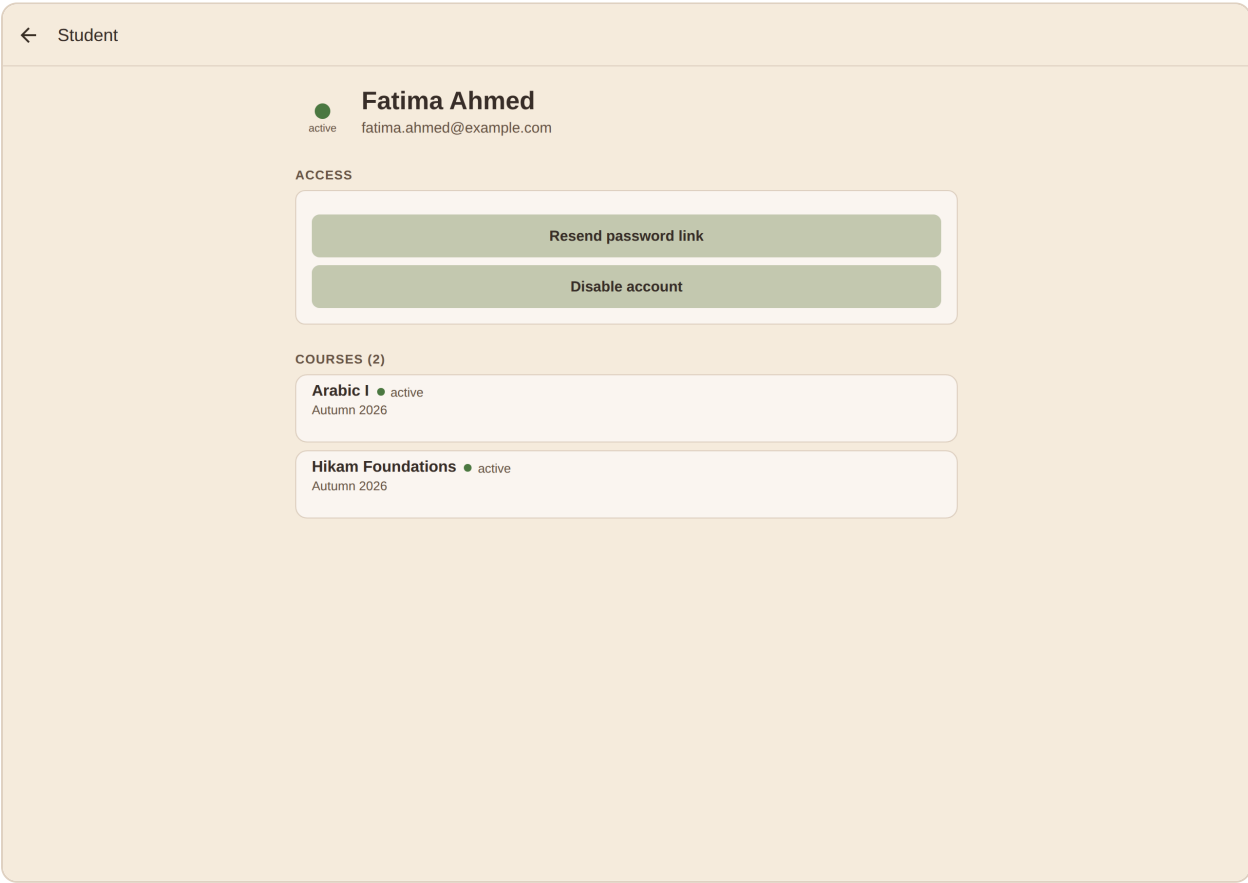
To add a student, enter their **full name** and **email**, optionally **enrol them in a course** right away, and tap **Create account**. The app emails them a link to set their own password — you never handle passwords.

The list itself is just for finding someone. **Tap a student to open their page**, where everything about them lives. Students you've disabled move out of the main list into a **Disabled** section at the bottom — tap the heading to open it.

A student’s page



On a phone



It shows their name, address and whether they're **active** or **disabled**, and carries the two actions:

- **Resend password link** — if they lost the email or the link expired.
- **Disable account** — turns off access without deleting anything. (Disable, don't delete — deletion is a separate, deliberate, admin-only step.) Admins only; managers see the state but not the switch, because access spans every course.

Below that are **the courses they're in**. Tap one to open that student's listening progress for it.

If you're a **manager**, this lists the courses *you* manage — it's headed **Courses you manage** to say so. You aren't shown classes you don't run, so treat it as your view of the student rather than their whole record. An admin sees every course.

2.12 Notifications (*staff*)

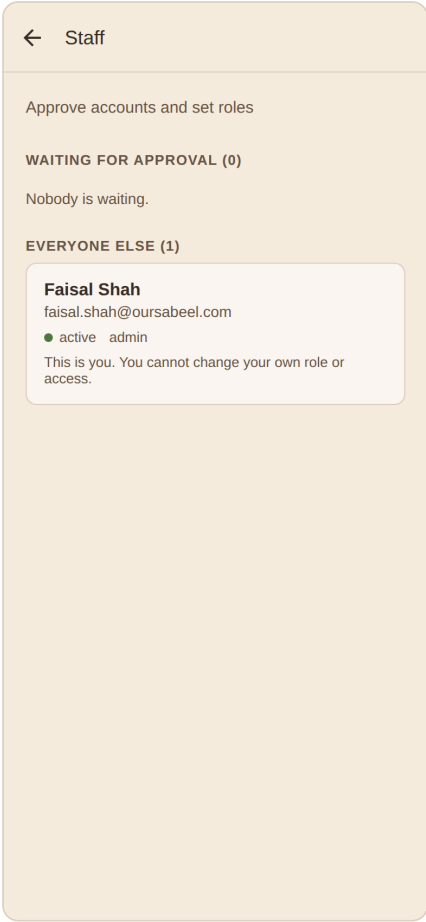
Tap **Notifications** on your home screen. Staff get one message:

- **Attendance still not taken** — a couple of days after a class meeting whose attendance you never submitted.

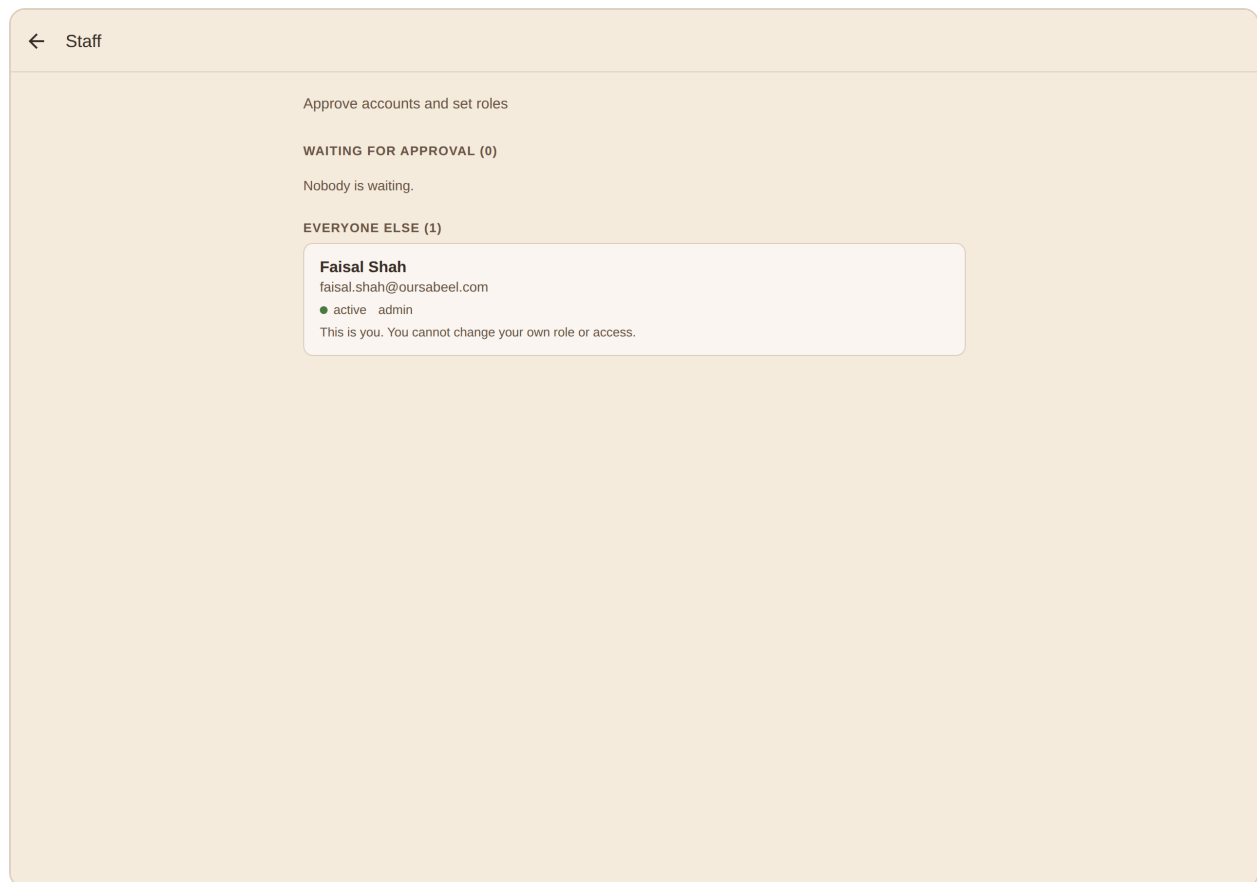
It's more useful than it sounds. Until attendance is submitted nobody has been excused, so a recording you've already published is sitting there that not one student can open — and nothing else in the app tells you.

Part 3 — For admins

3.1 Approving staff



On a phone



On a computer

New staff who sign in with Google land in **Waiting for approval**. For each, you choose the role as you approve:

- **Approve as manager** — they can run the courses you later assign to them.
- **Approve as admin** — full access, including approving other staff.

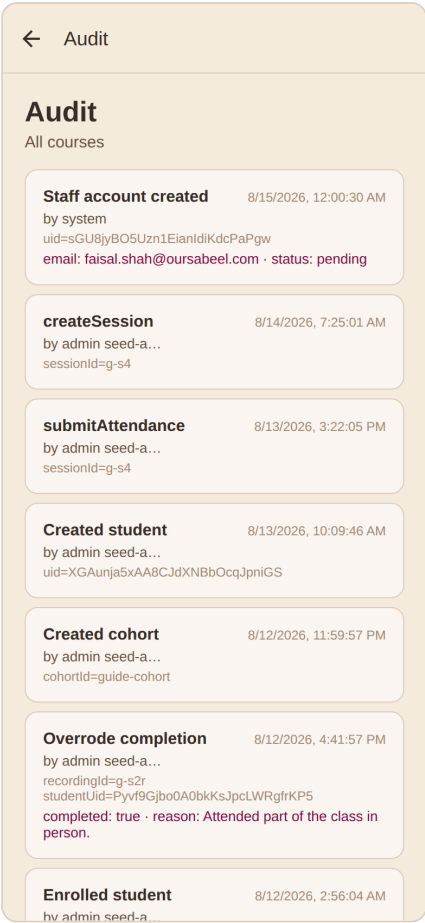
Below, **Everyone else** lists active staff. Your own account is marked “This is you” — you can’t change your own role or access, which stops an admin from accidentally locking themselves out.

Only staff on the institute’s own Google domain can be approved at all — the app checks this on the server, not just in the browser.

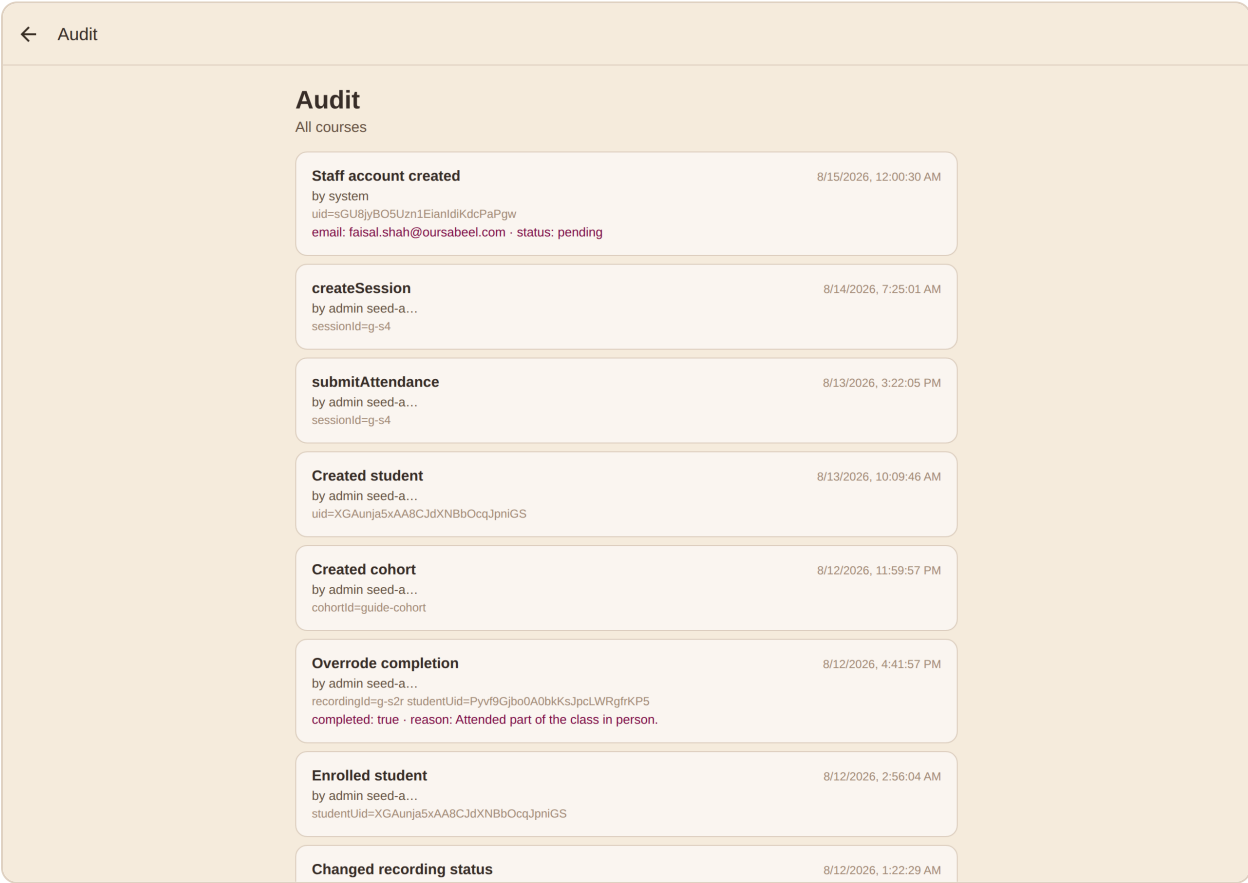
3.2 Managers are scoped course by course

A manager can’t see anything until you give them a course. Do that on the **course page** (Section 2.3), under **Managers** — add them there, and they’ll see that course’s sessions, recordings, ledgers, attendance, and audit, and nothing else. Putting a course in a cohort a manager works in does *not* grant access; the assignment is always the specific course.

3.3 The audit history



On a phone



The **audit history** is the running record of consequential actions — staff approvals, attendance submissions, completion overrides (with their reasons), recording edits — newest first. Each entry shows *who* did *what*, *when*, and the details that matter.

You can reach it two ways: **globally** from the staff home (admins, all courses), or **scoped to one course** from that course's page (managers see their own courses' history). It's there so that “who marked this complete, and why?” always has an answer.

3.4 Disable and archive — don't delete

The app is built around **reversible** actions:

- **Disable** a student or staff member to switch off access while keeping their history.
- **Unpublish** a recording to pull it from students without losing it.
- **Archive** a course when a term ends — its history stays intact, and you decide whether students may still listen to it.

Permanent deletion exists, but it's deliberately admin-only, asks for strong confirmation, and is audited. Reach for disable, unpublish, or archive first.

Part 4 — “How do I...?” quick answers

I want to...	Do this
Listen to something I missed	Home → tap the card → big round button.
Pick up where I left off	Just reopen it — your place is saved automatically, on any device.
Slow down or speed up	Tap 1×–2× on the player.
Mark something done	Press play once, then Mark complete at the bottom of the player.
See my attendance for a class	Home → My classes → tap the class.
Set my student password	Open the emailed link, or tap Email me a password link on sign-in.
Add a session <i>(staff)</i>	Course → Sessions → title + date → Create session .
Take attendance <i>(staff)</i>	Session → mark Present / Absent / Excused → Submit attendance .
Add a recording <i>(staff)</i>	Open the session → Upload audio... (or import from Zoom).
Open a recording to students <i>(staff)</i>	Mark them Excused , then Publish — that is the whole of it.
Change the closing date <i>(staff)</i>	Session → Edit session → Listen by . Moving it forward reopens a closed recording.
See who’s behind <i>(staff)</i>	Session → Listening progress → Not complete / Missed .
Give someone credit anyway <i>(staff)</i>	Ledger → Override → reason (required) → Mark complete .
Make a latecomer catch up on an old session <i>(staff)</i>	Open that session → mark them Excused → Submit attendance . (Move Listen by forward first if it has passed.)
See course attendance <i>(staff)</i>	Course → Attendance report (toggle by session / by student).
Export for records <i>(staff)</i>	Any ledger or the attendance report → Export CSV .
Turn a notification off	Home → Notifications → tap the one you don’t want.
Approve a new teacher <i>(admin)</i>	Home → Staff → Approve as manager / admin .
Give a manager a course <i>(admin)</i>	Course page → Managers → add them.
Create a student <i>(admin)</i>	Home → Students → name + email → Create account .

I want to...	Do this
See who changed what (<i>admin</i>)	Home → Audit history .

Troubleshooting

I signed in but I’m stuck on an “approval” screen. (*Staff*) New accounts wait for an admin to approve them. The screen updates by itself the moment they do — no refresh needed. If you’re stuck, contact your administrator.

A student can’t sign in. Check the email address matches the one on their account exactly, then open their page from the Students screen and use **Resend password link** so they can set a fresh password. New students have no password until they use that link.

The audio won’t play. Streaming needs a working connection — try switching between Wi-Fi and mobile data. Play links refresh automatically, so simply reopening the recording usually clears a stale one.

A student says they shouldn’t be on the hook for a recording. Check that session’s attendance — required listening follows it. If they were there, mark them **Present** and re-submit; the obligation drops (and any listening they did is kept). If they genuinely missed it, that’s exactly what the required listing is for.

I marked something complete but it still shows incomplete. If you were offline, the app is holding your mark and will sync it once you’re back online; it may briefly show as pending. If a *teacher* has overridden your status, their mark takes precedence — that’s by design.

A manager can’t see a course. Managers only see courses they’re assigned to. An admin adds them under **Managers** on the specific course page — being in the cohort isn’t enough.

Where did a recording go? It may have been **unpublished** (back to draft) or its course **archived**. Both are reversible — check the session or the course settings.